# AI-Assisted Project Management Workflow

How a project manager can use AI responsibly: assistant, not decision-maker

| | |
|---|---|
| **Document** | 23 - AI-Assisted PM Workflow |
| **Project** | AI Customer Support Platform (fictional company: Kestrel Commerce Ltd.) |
| **Prepared by** | Project Manager (portfolio author) - self-directed simulation |
| **Status** | v1.0 |
| **Project window** | 5 Jan - 13 Mar 2026 (simulated project window) |

SIMULATED PROJECT - Self-directed portfolio case study. Not professional experience, not client work, not employment. All people, figures and outcomes are fictional.

AI is an assistant, not the decision-maker. The project manager remains responsible for reviewing, validating, prioritising, deciding, communicating and approving.

## 1. Principles

- Use AI to speed up drafting and thinking; never to replace judgement, accountability or stakeholder conversations.
- Treat every AI output as an unverified draft: check facts, numbers, names and dates against the project logs.
- Keep the logs (backlog, risk register, decision log) as the single source of truth, not chat history.
- Do not paste confidential or personal data into tools that are not approved for it.
- Be transparent that AI assisted a draft, and keep the PM's name on the decisions.

## 2. Where AI helps in this project

| PM task | How AI assists | Example prompt | What I review and decide |
|---|---|---|---|
| **Drafting documentation** | First drafts of charter sections, scope wording and requirement phrasing from my notes. | Draft the business case from these notes in 200 words; mark every assumption. | I check every fact and number against source notes, remove filler, align terms across documents and own the final text. |
| **Initial user-story drafts** | Turns a requirement into INVEST-style stories with draft Given/When/Then criteria. | Convert FR-14 into 2-3 stories of 8 points or fewer with testable acceptance criteria. | The Product Owner and team refine, estimate and accept; I check traceability and that nothing new has crept in. |
| **Brainstorming risks** | Widens thinking by category (AI, security, data, schedule, people) with early-warning signs. | List risks for an LLM-based support chatbot MVP by category, with triggers. | I merge duplicates, drop generic items, score with the team, assign owners and decide mitigations. Risk acceptance is a human decision. |
| **Summarising meetings** | Converts notes into decisions, actions (owner, date) and open questions. | Summarise into decisions, actions and open questions; add nothing not stated. | I verify against notes, confirm actions with owners and never treat the summary as the record of a decision on its own. |
| **Drafting status reports** | Produces a first draft from sprint metrics, the risk log and issue log. | From these metrics and logs, draft a one-page status; flag any inconsistencies. | I set the RAG status, check numbers against the board, choose what leadership must hear and frame the decisions required. |
| **Analysing project information** | Spots patterns and gaps: stories without tasks, duplicated requirements, velocity trends. | Compare story IDs in the backlog with the WBS and list stories without a task. | I verify results against the source (or with a script), interpret them and decide what to act on. |
| **Stakeholder communications** | Drafts emails and decision requests in different tones. | Draft a decision request to the Sponsor with two options and a recommendation in 150 words. | I adapt tone to the relationship, verify facts and send it under my name. |
| **Identifying dependencies** | Suggests missing links between work packages and with external parties. | Given this WBS, suggest missing dependencies and sequencing risks. | I validate with tech leads; only confirmed dependencies enter the log and schedule. |
| **Retrospective summaries** | Clusters retro notes into themes and proposes actions. | Cluster these comments into themes; suggest at most 3 actions per theme. | The team chooses the actions; I assign owners and follow them up. |

## 3. The PM remains responsible for

| Responsibility | Why it cannot be delegated to AI |
|---|---|
| **Reviewing and validating outputs** | AI can be fluent and wrong; accuracy is the PM's accountability. |
| **Prioritising** | Trade-offs depend on business context and stakeholder commitments. |
| **Decision-making** | Decisions need authority and accountability. |
| **Stakeholder communication** | Trust and tone depend on relationships. |
| **Risk decisions** | Accepting, avoiding or transferring a risk is a management decision. |
| **Scope decisions** | Change control needs impact judgement and approval rights. |
| **Final approval** | Documents and releases carry the PM's name. |

## 4. Worked example: from interview notes to backlog (illustrative)

1. I paste anonymised notes from the Support Manager interview and ask the AI to list candidate requirements and open questions.
2. I discard duplicates, rewrite vague items with measurable wording (for example 'fast' becomes 'p95 of 8 seconds or less') and tag each with a source.
3. I ask the AI to draft stories and Given/When/Then criteria for the agreed requirements; the Product Owner edits and approves.
4. I use a script to check every story links to a requirement and a work package, and that sprint dates agree.
5. I take the result to refinement; the team estimates; I record decisions in the log.

## 5. Risks of using AI as a PM and how I manage them

| Risk | Control |
|---|---|
| **Plausible but wrong content** | Check against logs; cite sources; keep numbers in spreadsheets, not prose. |
| **Generic filler that hides real thinking** | Edit hard; remove anything that does not trace to project facts. |
| **Confidentiality** | Use anonymised data and approved tools only. |
| **Over-reliance and skill fade** | Do the prioritisation, scoring and decisions myself; use AI to challenge, not to decide. |
| **Bias in suggestions** | Ask for alternatives; compare with team input. |

## 6. Disclosure for this portfolio

The documents in this repository were drafted with the help of an AI assistant. The author is responsible for reviewing and validating them, and cross-references (IDs, dates, story points, dependencies) were checked with scripts. This follows the same rule as above: AI drafts, the project manager decides.